FIGHTERBASE

Whole-food plant-based

Diet guide

Vegan, mostly unprocessed.



Prepared 10 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Whole-food plant-based**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Whole-food plant-based?

Plants in as close to their whole form as possible: beans, grains, veg, fruit, nuts. Little oil, sugar or processed food.

Where it comes from

Popularised in the late twentieth century by doctors and researchers who studied the health effects of plant-heavy eating. It is a vegan diet that also limits processed foods.

The main ideas

1. Vegetables, fruit, legumes, wholegrains, nuts and seeds.
2. No animal products.
3. Refined sugar, white flour and highly processed foods are minimised.
4. Added oils are limited or avoided in the strictest versions (some versions allow a little olive oil).
5. Most food is eaten close to its natural form.

Who it suits

- People who want a vegan diet without relying on processed substitutes
- People focusing on fibre and plant variety

> **Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:**
>
> - You are pregnant or breastfeeding
> - You are a child or teenager
> - You are underweight or a heavy-training athlete struggling to eat enough
> - You have a history of disordered eating (strict rules can be risky)

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Whole foods are bulky and filling, so athletes can struggle to get enough calories. Include dense foods: nut butter, avocado, dried fruit, tahini.
- Potatoes, rice, oats, bananas, dates and wholegrain bread give carbs.
- Lentils, beans, tofu, tempeh and peas provide protein.
- If you cannot eat enough on whole foods alone, add some plant protein powder or refined foods and do not feel bad about it.

> Very high fibre can sit heavy before sessions: choose lower-fibre carbs like bananas, white rice or oats close to training.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Vitamin B12
not in plant foods
Where: a B12 supplement or fortified foods. Essential

Vitamin D
low UK winter sun
Where: a vitamin D supplement

Calories
whole plant foods are low in energy density
Where: nuts, seeds, avocado, dried fruit, wholegrain bread

Iron, calcium, iodine, omega-3
as for any vegan diet
Where: see the Vegan guide: greens, tofu, fortified milk, algae oil

Common mistakes

- Not eating enough calories for training
- Skipping B12
- Too many rules, leading to fear around food
- Labelling any food as bad

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Look for short ingredient lists
- Avoid products listing refined oil, sugar, white flour as main ingredients
- Fortified plant milks are usually fine and help with calcium and B12

Eating out

- Choose bean and grain bowls, vegetable curries, salads with legumes, soups.
- Ask for dressings on the side.
- Fries and refined bread are the 'sometimes' items.

Easy swaps

White rice	→	Brown rice or quinoa
White bread	→	Wholegrain bread
Oil in cooking	→	Water or stock to saute, or a little olive oil
Sugar	→	Fruit or dates

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Porridge with berries and flax	Lentil and vegetable soup, wholegrain bread	Bean and vegetable chilli with brown rice
Tue	Wholegrain toast with avocado	Chickpea and quinoa salad	Sweet potato and black bean tacos
Wed	Overnight oats with fruit	Hummus, veg and wholegrain wrap	Tofu and vegetable stir-fry with brown rice
Thu	Smoothie with oats, banana, spinach	Baked potato with beans and salsa	Lentil dahl with greens
Fri	Muesli (no sugar) with soya milk	Three bean salad	Mushroom and barley stew
Sat	Banana pancakes (oats, banana)	Vegetable soup and wholegrain bread	Tempeh and vegetable noodle bowl
Sun	Fruit bowl with nuts and seeds	Leftovers bowl	Roast vegetables and chickpeas with tahini

Snacks

Fruit · Nuts and dates · Hummus and veg · Popcorn (air-popped) · Roasted chickpeas

Shopping list

Fortified unsweetened plant milk · Beans, lentils, chickpeas · Brown rice, oats, quinoa, wholegrain bread, potatoes · Vegetables and fruit (fresh and frozen) · Nuts, seeds, tahini, dates · B12 supplement

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Is oil really banned?

It depends who you ask. Some programmes avoid it, others allow olive oil in small amounts. Athletes often need the extra calories.

Is it healthier than a normal vegan diet?

It can be higher in fibre and lower in processed food. It is not necessarily better for everyone, and can be hard to keep up.

Further reading

The Vegan Society; British Dietetic Association; NHS.

For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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